

SPM 261 • WEEK 8-1

# SCIENCE OF FANDOM:

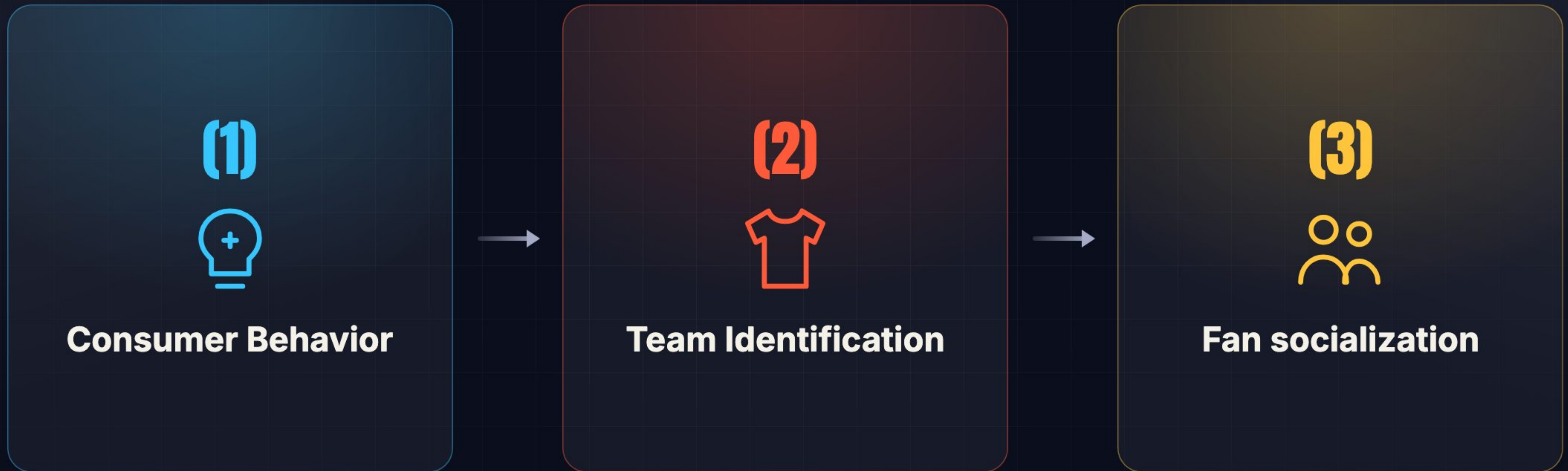
## A Framework of Sport Consumerism

SPM261 Introduction to Sport Management



# A FRAMEWORK OF SPORT CONSUMERISM

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# CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

“

The dynamic interaction of affect and cognition, behavior, and the environment by which human beings conduct the exchange aspects of their lives”

(American Marketing Association, 2008).

*A textbook definition of consumer behavior is generally,*

“

The study of individuals, groups, or organizations and the processes they use to select, secure, use, and dispose of products, services, experiences, or idea to satisfy needs and the impacts that these processes have on the consumer and society”

(Hawkins, Best, & Coney, 2004, p. 7).

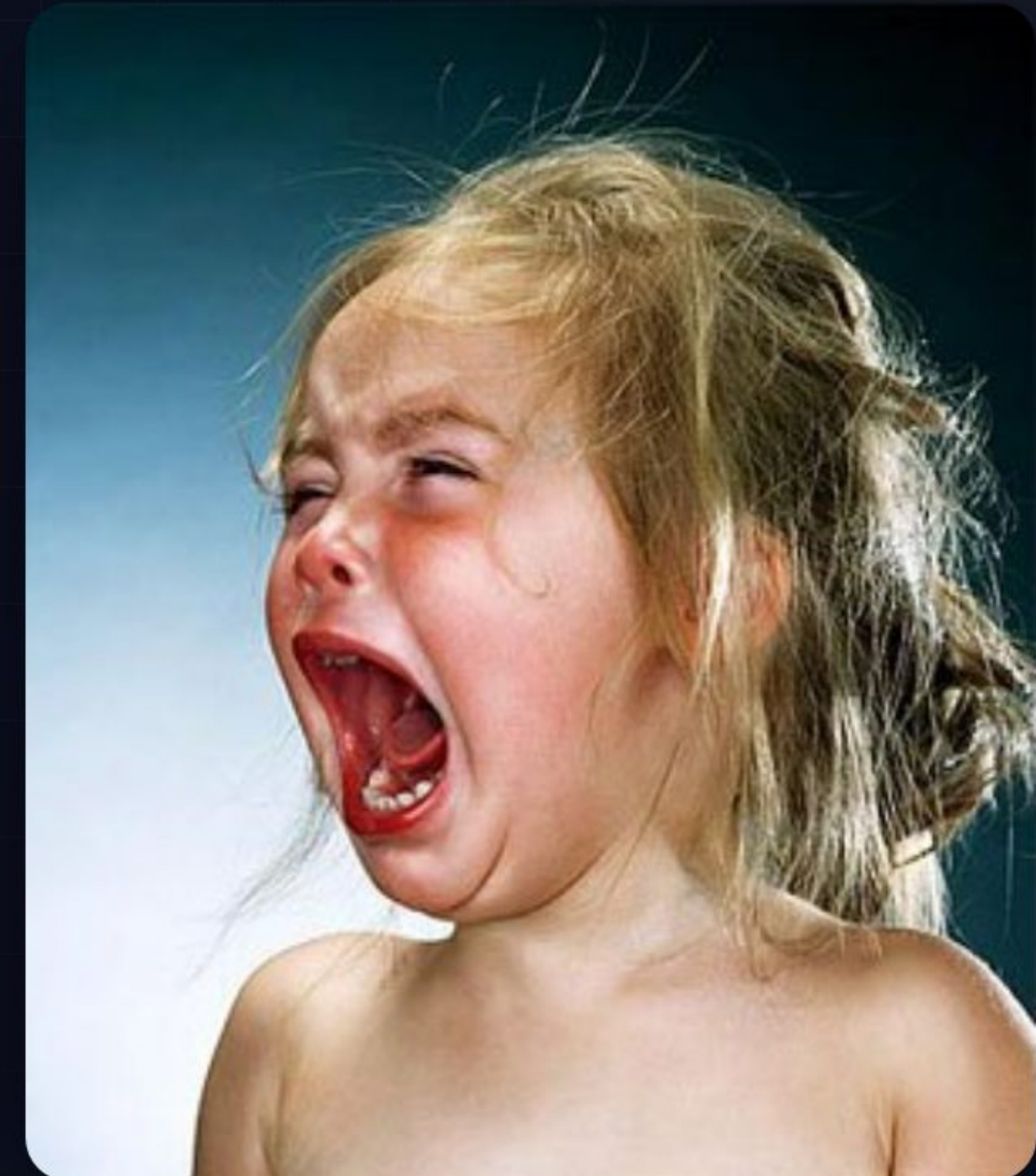
# SIMPLE DEFINITION OF CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

**“THE STUDY OF WHY PEOPLE BUY.”**

(Trail & James, 2013, p.38)

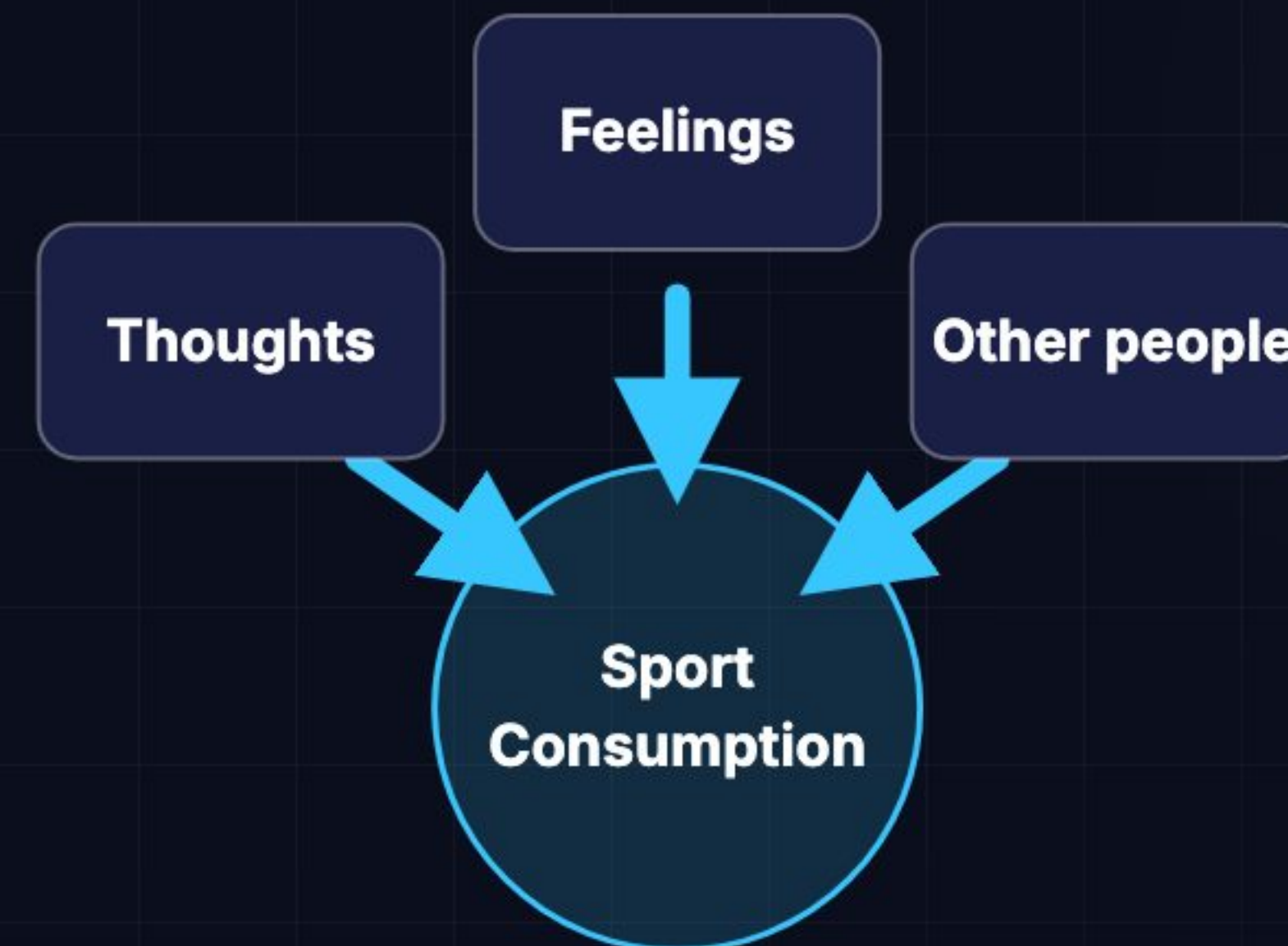
**DECISION MAKING PROCESS**

**ARE YOU KIDDING?**



## FACTORS AFFECTING SPORT CONSUMPTION

**THINK ABOUT WHAT OTHER  
FACTORS INFLUENCE YOUR SPORT  
CONSUMPTION?????**



# WHO ARE SPORT CONSUMERS?



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gzTGwR47PDU>



<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1q5V6DKH3bw>



# FANDOM

- ◆ Sport consumers can be categorized by their level of fandom (i.e., the degree they are a fan or not).
- ◆ It's critical for managers to know whether someone is a fan of their team. Why?

Not all consumers are equally passionate.

Neither are they all resistant to change that threatens team values and practices.

Some attend games on a regular basis, while others attend only on special occasions.

Stewart et al. (2003)



**Challenges of narrowing a set of homogeneous traits**

● CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

# SPORT CONSUMER DATA

Ex) Pittsburgh  
Penguins

Ex) 49ers



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8YD5HcnVYd4&t=10s>

# TEAM IDENTIFICATION

**"The extent that a fan psychologically connected to a team"** (Wann, 1997)

Sense of belongingness to a team



**More like to attend games regardless of team performance**

**Less complaint**

**Higher purchase intentions toward the team sponsor's products**

# TEAM IDENTIFICATION CONT.



(SBJ, 2016)

WHICH OF THE FOLLOWING IS AN OFFICIAL SPONSOR OF THE NBA?

| INSURANCE    | AVID  |       |       | CASUAL |       |       |
|--------------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|
|              | 2016  | 2015  | 2014  | 2016   | 2015  | 2014  |
| State Farm*  | 28.0% | 20.5% | 22.4% | 16.5%  | 17.4% | 8.0%  |
| Geico        | 15.5% | 17.5% | 13.9% | 14.5%  | 12.9% | 11.6% |
| Allstate     | 13.0% | 12.0% | 12.4% | 10.5%  | 10.9% | 9.5%  |
| Progressive  | 6.5%  | 7.0%  | 6.0%  | 4.0%   | 6.0%  | 6.5%  |
| I'm not sure | 32.0% | 31.5% | 37.8% | 47.0%  | 43.3% | 56.3% |

Are you more or less likely to consciously support a company by purchasing its products/services if the company is an official sponsor of the NBA?

|                          | AVID  |       |       | CASUAL |       |       |
|--------------------------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|
|                          | 2016  | 2015  | 2014  | 2016   | 2015  | 2014  |
| More likely              | 62.0% | 53.5% | 53.8% | 36.0%  | 36.9% | 29.1% |
| Unaffected / less likely | 38.0% | 46.5% | 46.3% | 64.0%  | 63.2% | 70.8% |

Are you more or less likely to recommend a product/service to a friend or family member if that product/service is an official sponsor of the NBA?

|                          | AVID  |       |       | CASUAL |       |       |
|--------------------------|-------|-------|-------|--------|-------|-------|
|                          | 2016  | 2015  | 2014  | 2016   | 2015  | 2014  |
| More likely              | 62.0% | 52.0% | 51.8% | 36.5%  | 33.9% | 26.6% |
| Unaffected / less likely | 38.0% | 48.0% | 48.3% | 63.5%  | 66.2% | 73.4% |

# TEAM IDENTIFICATION CONT.

The 2017 Women's college basketball NCAA Championship game (Mississippi State vs. South Carolina) drew **3.8 million** viewers.



3.8M



NCAA

528K



WNBA

**DRASTIC GAP, WHY?**

The fifth game of the 2016 WNBA Finals drew about **528,000** viewers.



## TEAM IDENTIFICATION CONT.

# BIRGing

## Basking in Reflected Glory

People wear a team jersey or climb on a team's bandwagon because they believe that associating with a winner makes them a winner (i.e., self-esteem).



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-MXiQk2zc60>



## TEAM IDENTIFICATION CONT.

# CORFing

Cutting Off Reflected Failure

People distance themselves from a loser for fear that a connection would make them look like losers.

**Cubs fans...**

<http://espn.go.com/mlb/attendance>



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CqeLZ7vVLYE>



# FAN SOCIALIZATION

- ◆ It's important to spend some time discussing how people become fans in the first place.
- ◆ Try and think back to when you first became a fan of a team, or even if you more recently became a fan of a team, what caused you to become a fan?



# FAN SOCIALIZATION CONT.

## FAN SOCIALIZATION QUESTIONS



**SEE HANDOUT**

# FAN SOCIALIZATION CONT.

Kolbe and James (2000)



Fan socialization involves learning and internalizing the attitudes, values, knowledge and behaviors that are associated with fans of a team. This process results in individual-level internalizations and an appreciation of the importance of being a fan of the team"

(p. 3).

## When can you become a fan of a team?

→ People can be socialized into being fans at any point during the life span.

# FAN SOCIALIZATION CONT.



Kolbe and James (2000)

- ◆ Conducted interviews, focus groups, and a mail survey with fans of the Cleveland Browns.
- ◆ Fans were asked to identify (1) "the one person who had the most influence on them becoming a Browns fan," and (2) "how important various activities like attending games in person were to them becoming a fan."



**38.8%**

→ "Father"



**56%**

→ Prior to age 15 and between 6 and 15 years of age.

# FAN SOCIALIZATION CONT.



Kolbe and James (2000)

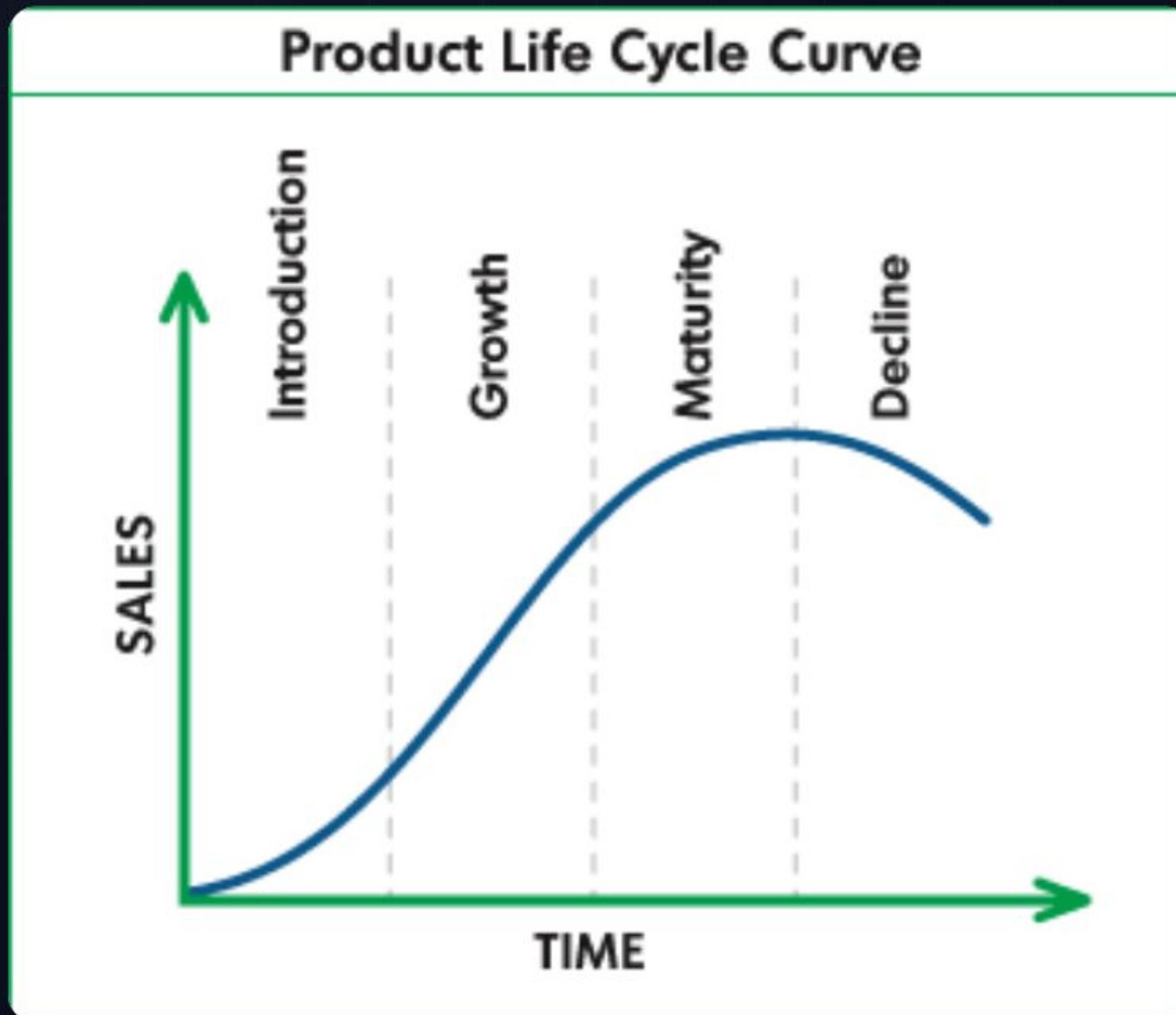
- ◆ Adult fans indicated that a distinct difference from the other groups in that players and coaches contributed most to their attachment with a professional football team.
- ◆ Emotional connection between the city and the team.

## DISCUSS

**What are implications from this information?**

**Any practical implications for the sport managers?**

# FAN SOCIALIZATION ACROSS THE LIFE CYCLE



Childhood

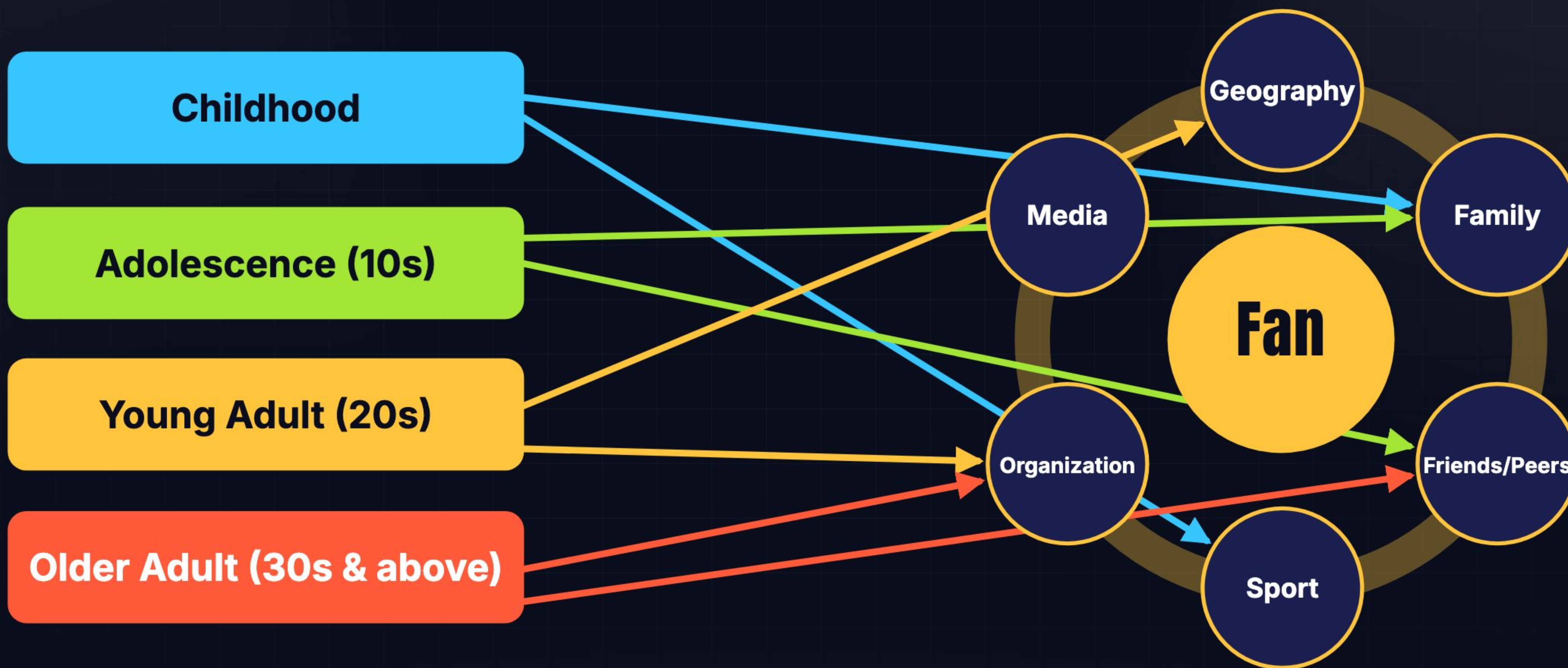
Adolescence (10s)

Young Adult (20s)

Older Adult (30s & above)

A lifecycle perspective is used to consider how the various agents may influence fan socialization, and to what extent specific agents may have more or less impact at different points in one's life.

# SOCIALIZING AGENTS & FAN CYCLE (James & Trail, 2015)



# QUESTIONS?

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